Annual Report for ODE Integrated Guidance 2025–2026

About the Report

- The annual report for 2025-2026 Integrated Guidance is due to ODE on September 30, 2026.
- The outcomes and strategies in our 2025-2026 Integrated Guidance Plan were pulled directly from the district priorities/District Continuous Improvement Plan (DCIP)*(2025-27 Integrated Plan w/Strategies + Outcomes)*
- This response was written based on PPS strategies and outcomes overall and not just the Integrated Guidance Plan, which represents about 2-3% of the PPS budget.
- The annual report must be posted on our website and presented at an open Board meeting.
- This aligns with responses in our 2024-2025 Annual Report

Annual Report Questions

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AR1. As you review your progress markers/overall reflection responses and reflect on plan implementation, how do you see your progress contributing to the Outcomes and Strategies in your plan and your Longitudinal Performance Growth Targets (LPGT)/Local Optional Metrics (LOM)? Discuss at least one Outcome where you have seen progress in implementation.

Throughout the 2025–26 school year, Portland Public Schools continued to strengthen the connection between district priorities, school improvement efforts, and the outcomes identified in our Integrated Guidance Plan. Our implementation focused on building consistent systems for high-quality instruction, using data to inform decisions, strengthening multi-tiered systems of support, and addressing disparities in student outcomes. Together, these efforts support continued progress toward the district's Longitudinal Performance Growth Targets in literacy, mathematics, attendance, 9th Grade On-Track, and graduation.

One area of significant implementation progress has been literacy and instructional improvement. PPS continued the districtwide implementation of evidence- and research-based literacy curricula across PK–12 while strengthening the professional learning, assessment, and instructional tools that support effective classroom practice. During 2025–26, 19 Cohort 2 elementary schools completed yearlong Science of Reading professional learning, and 215 secondary educators participated in the Secondary Integrated Literacy Summer Institute. The district also refined K–12 instructional walk tools and ELA scope and sequence guidance to strengthen coherence across curriculum, instruction, professional learning, and monitoring.

PPS also continued to strengthen its balanced assessment system to provide educators with more timely information about student learning. The district updated its PK–12 assessment calendar and guidance, expanded the use of curriculum-embedded assessments, and piloted common assessments for grades 6–12 through a shared digital platform. These efforts are intended to help educators identify student needs earlier, adjust instruction, and provide additional support when needed.

Attendance and student engagement remained another significant area of focus. Schools continued developing and strengthening attendance teams and using disaggregated student data to identify barriers, conduct root-cause analysis, and connect students and families with appropriate supports. More than 65% of PPS schools identified and staffed Attendance Support and Early Response Teams (ASERT), and Community School Site Coordinators continued partnering with school teams to support students experiencing attendance barriers. By the end of 2025–26, 68.8% of PPS students had good or acceptable attendance, representing a 2.1 percentage point increase from the previous school year.

Across these areas, PPS also continued strengthening the systems that support equitable decision-making and continuous improvement. Schools and district teams increasingly used disaggregated data, comprehensive needs assessments, School Continuous Improvement Plans, and district equity tools to identify student needs and align strategies and investments. This work is helping create greater coherence between district priorities, school-level improvement efforts, and the allocation of state, federal, and local resources.

Overall, progress during 2025–26 reflects continued development of the instructional, data, and student-support systems necessary to improve outcomes over time. While implementation varies across schools and grade levels, PPS has strengthened the foundation for sustained improvement and will continue focusing on consistency, monitoring impact, and ensuring that improvements reach students who have historically experienced disparities in outcomes.

AR2. Where have you experienced barriers, challenges, or impediments to progress toward your Outcomes and Strategies in your plan that you could use support with? Discuss at least one Outcome where you have seen challenges or barriers to implementation.

While PPS made progress in literacy, attendance, assessment, and school improvement systems during 2025–26, challenges remain in achieving consistent implementation across a large and complex school system. These challenges are particularly evident in high school success, 9th Grade On-Track, student belonging and engagement, and the coordination of intensive student supports.

At the high school level, persistent operational and instructional challenges continue to affect credit attainment and students' ability to remain on track for graduation. Student Success Teams use disaggregated course-performance data and provide opportunities for students to recover credits and receive additional support. However, schools vary in their capacity to provide immediate and flexible credit-completion opportunities when students begin falling behind.

Scheduling complexity also remains a challenge, particularly for emerging bilingual and multilingual learners. Schools must balance English Language Development requirements with access to core credit-bearing courses, Career and Technical Education, advanced coursework, and other graduation requirements. These competing requirements can create barriers to ensuring that students have equitable access to both the supports they need and the courses necessary to remain on track for graduation.

Student belonging, voice, and engagement are also areas where PPS continues to strengthen its approach. All elementary and middle schools implemented district-adopted Social Emotional Learning curricula during 2025–26, while high schools continued developing more consistent approaches to belonging and engagement. Student Success Teams also used strategies such as 9th Grade Cafes and empathy interviews to better understand students' experiences and barriers. District survey results showed a two-percentage-point increase in sense of belonging among students in grades 6–12, while results for students in grades 3–5 decreased by one percentage point. These results reinforce the need to continue strengthening student voice, relationships, school climate, and culturally responsive learning environments across grade levels.

PPS also continues to address challenges within Tier II and Tier III student-support systems. During 2025–26, internal reviews identified opportunities to improve role clarity, referral and escalation pathways, safety planning, behavioral supports, and coordination among school and district teams. The district is responding by developing clearer guidance and processes for intensive supports and strengthening coordination across Student Support Services. At the secondary level, additional opportunities to learn from evidence-based practices and other large districts could also support our efforts to strengthen 9th-grade success, student belonging, and intervention systems. Districts need clear, timely, and

actionable guidance, greater consistency in state expectations and sustained partnership when navigating complex implementation challenges.

Finally, changes in available funding and regional partnerships continue to require careful prioritization. As temporary relief funds end and partner funding shifts, PPS must continue strategically coordinating state, federal, and local resources to protect high-impact investments in literacy, attendance, 9th-grade success, community partnerships, and college and career pathways.

Moving forward, PPS will continue focusing on strengthening implementation across schools, improving coordination among instructional and student-support systems, using disaggregated data to monitor impact, and elevating student and family voice in continuous improvement. These efforts will help ensure that the systems established through Integrated Guidance translate into sustained and equitable improvements in student experiences and outcomes. We also recognize that districts cannot address every systemic barrier independently. We also need strong state and district partnership in addressing systemic barriers. Continued progress would be strengthened through ODE's ongoing partnership in providing clear and timely guidance, consistent expectations, and sustained support as districts navigate complex implementation and resource decisions. Working together in this way will help strengthen coherence across state and local efforts and support more consistent and equitable outcomes for students across Oregon.